# AA–T–91a

**MAY 31, 1955**

**SUPERSEDING**
**Fed. Spec. AA–T–91**
**1 August 1933, and**
**Int. Fed. Spec. AA–T–0091a (GSA–FSS)**
**Revision—1, dated 18 December 1953**

**FEDERAL SPECIFICATION**

# TABLES, STEEL, GENERAL OFFICE

*This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.*

## 1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

**1.1 Scope.**—The steel tables covered by this specification are the Federal standard general office type, with a linoleum top. A combination or grouping of the sizes specified will result in a suitable arrangement for the desired seating capacity in small conference rooms.

**1.2 Classification.**

**1.2.1** *Type and size.*—The tables shall be of but one type, as shown in figure 1, and of the following sizes, as specified in the invitation for bids:

Size 1.—45 inches wide by 34 inches deep by 30½ inches high (one drawer).

Size 2.—60 inches wide by 34 inches deep by 30½ inches high (one drawer).

**1.2.2** *Colors of finish.*—The colors of finish shall be as specified and shall match the following standard colors adopted by the Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration:

Gray

Olive Green

(Sample panels of the standard colors of finish and samples of the standard colors of linoleum are obtainable, without charge, from the Regional Office Building, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington 25, D. C., or from the Business Service Center of the nearest GSA Regional Office.)

## 2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

**2.1** The following specifications and standards of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

*Federal Specifications:*

NN–B–621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.

LLL–B–631—Boxes; Fiber, Corrugated (for domestic shipment).

LLL–L–354—Linoleum; Desk Top.

PPP–B–601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.

*Military Specifications:*

JAN–P–106—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Boxes; Wood, Nailed.

MIL–C–490—Cleaning and Preparation of Ferrous and Zinc Coated Surfaces for Organic Protective Coating.

MIL–L–10547—Liners, Case, Waterproof.

*Military Standards:*

MIL–STD–105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

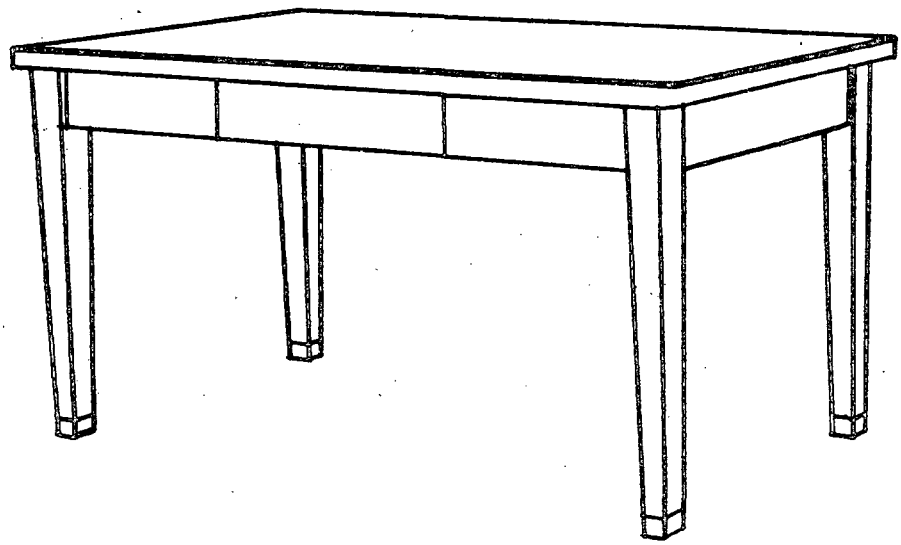
MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

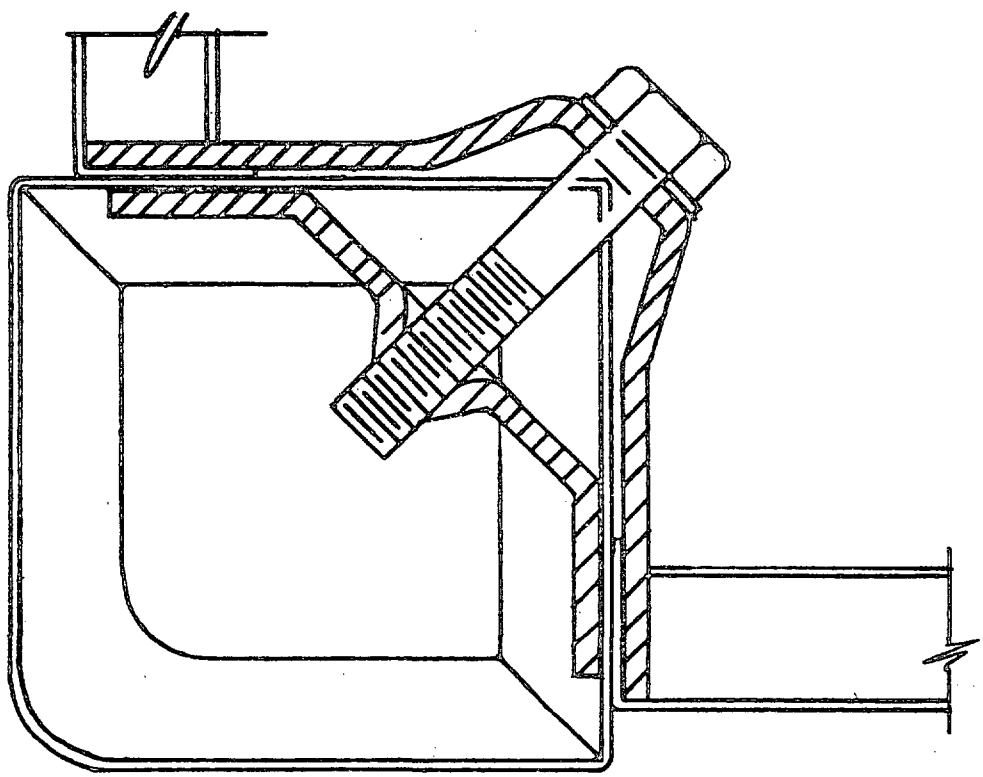
MIL–STD–130—Identification Marking for U. S. Military Property.

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FULL SIZE SECTION OF LEG MOUNT

FIGURE 1.



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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

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(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

## 3. REQUIREMENTS

### 3.1 Material.

**3.1.1** *Steel.*—The steel sheets used for all exposed parts shall be cold rolled, stretcher leveled, full pickled and oiled, and free from imperfections. Other sheets shall be hot rolled, pickled and oiled. The sheet steel for parts to be formed shall withstand the bend test specified in 4.3.2. The gages shown herein are the Manufacturers' Standard Gage for Steel Sheet. The decimal equivalents shown for the steel-sheet thickness are subject to the established standard tolerances or ordering limits.

**3.1.2** *Linoleum.*—The linoleum shall conform to the requirements of Federal Specification LLL–L–354, except that burlap or felt back may be used. The thickness of linoleum shall be not less than 0.075 inch. The linoleum colors shall be green for olive-green tables, and gray for gray tables. The colors shall match the standard linoleum colors adopted by the Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration (see 1.2.2 for samples).

**3.1.3** *Hardware.*

**3.1.3.1** *Face hardware.*—The face hardware shall be satin-finished enameled or anodized aluminum or commercial type 430 corrosion-resistant steel or brushed chromium on steel or on die-cast zinc, brass, or bronze.

**3.1.3.2** *Foot sockets.*—The foot sockets shall be not less than 0.0299 inch thick and not less than 1½ inches high and shall conform to the shape of the leg. The foot sockets shall be flush with the outside surfaces of the leg and shall be firmly secured by fastenings which are designed to protect floors and to be removable with simple tools.

**3.1.3.3** *Linoleum binding strip.* — The linoleum binding strip shall be of the material as specified in 3.1.3.1. The strip shall have not less than 3/16 inch quarter round bead with the inside beveled to hold the beveled edge of the linoleum firmly secured to the top or edge molding but made easily removable in order to replace the linoleum. The top of the strip shall not project above the top surface of the linoleum.

**3.1.4** *Finishing materials.*

**3.1.4.1** *Cleaning.*—All metal surfaces, except exposed hardware, shall be cleaned, and surface preparation processed in accordance with any of the grades or types specified in Military Specification MIL–C–490, Cleaning and Preparation of Ferrous Metal Surfaces for Organic Protective Coatings.

**3.1.4.2** *Enamel.* — Enamel for the final coat shall be in accordance with manufacturers commercial practice, except the colors shall be as specified in 1.2.2 of this specification, and the enamel shall be baked for not less than 45 minutes at 300° F. or in accordance with the enamel manufacturer's directions. Enamel shall withstand the test specified in 4.3.3.

### 3.2 Construction.

**3.2.1** *Design.*—The design of the tables shall be as shown in figure 1, which illustrates the general exterior appearance and typical features of



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construction which shall be in accordance with the minimum detail requirements of this specification.

3.2.1.1 *Preproduction sample.*—When specified, before production is commenced, a sample table representative of those to be furnished in each size being procured, shall be submitted to the contracting officer for approval.

3.2.2 *Tolerance.*—Width of top, plus or minus ⅛ inch; depth of top, plus or minus ⅛ inch; height of top, minus ⅛ inch.

3.2.3 *Assembly.* — The leg attachment shall be by bolts, nuts and lockwashers, and extruded holes with self tapping screws. Boltholes shall be true and even in joining members. Welding shall be as specified for each part and pits or extortions on the face of the parts shall be filled and ground smooth, and shall not show on the exposed finished parts of the tables. The joining of all members shall result in a compact unit of sufficient strength to prevent the distortion, breakage, or loosening of any part of the table during heavy duty daily usage, and to withstand rough handling in moving.

3.2.4 *Tops.*—The top plate shall be not less than 18-gage (0.0478 inch) stretcher leveled steel, and shall be rigidly reinforced to meet the test specified in 4.3.1. The top plate shall be covered with linoleum as specified in 3.1.2, which shall be cemented uniformly to the top plate by a cement recommended by the linoleum manufacturer. The over-all height of the edge molding and the linoleum binder strip shall be not less than 1½ inches. The edge molding shall be not less in thickness than the thickness of the top plate and may be formed from one or more pieces, and shall provide for a linoleum binding strip as specified in 3.1.3.3 which shall be securely held in place but allow for easy removal and shall closely fit the linoleum. The exposed edge molding and the binder strip shall be of not more than two pieces each, and shall be butt joined on either or both ends of the table. All corners of the top shall be rounded on not less than ¾-inch radius. The bottom flange of the edge molding shall extend to the apron or shall be "U" shaped to eliminate sharp edges.

3.2.5 *Drawers.*—The drawer fronts shall have a double-wall construction. The outside drawer front shall be not less than 22-gage (0.0299 inch) steel with the ends and bottom edges box formed and flanged for spot welding to the drawer body and may serve as the drawer pull. The top edge of the outside drawer face shall be channeled. The inside drawer front shall be of not less than 24-gage (0.0239 inch) steel, flanged on all edges, and the top edge shall interlock with the top channel of the outside front, and the bottom edge shall be held in place by extrusions in the drawer bottom. The drawer body shall be formed from one piece of not less than 24-gage (0.0239 inch) steel, and the back edges shall be flanged for spot-welding of the back to the body. The top edge of all drawer sides shall have not less than 3/16-inch tight rolled bead. The back of the drawer shall be formed of steel not less than 24 gage (0.0239 inch), and the top edge of the back shall be folded or beaded for stiffening. Spot welds for all drawer assembly shall be on not more than 4-inch centers on horizontal assemblies and on not more than 2-inch centers for vertical assemblies.

3.2.5.1 *Drawer suspension.* — The drawers shall operate on channel type suspension. A channel of not less than 18-gage (0.0478 inch) steel shall be spot-welded by not less than two rows of spot welds to each drawer side, the spot welds shall be not more than 4 inches apart, horizontally, and the channel shall be shaped to eliminate all sharp edges and prevent personal contact with lubrication. The suspension channel or rail shall be formed from not less than 16-gage (0.0598 inch) steel, and shall be securely welded to the support members of the table. The support members shall be channel formed from not less than 20-gage (0.0359 inch) steel and shall be securely welded to the top plate or to the top reinforcements, and extended to the bottom of the apron. The ends shall be flanged and spot-welded to the aprons at the drawer openings. The drawer suspension shall be accurately formed to insure ease of operation without excessive friction, noise, wabble, or vibration and be of sufficient length to hold the drawer in a horizontal position (plus or minus ¼ inch) when the drawer is open and contains not less than 10 pounds of



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evenly distributed paper. Each drawer shall be equipped with metal stops which shall prevent the drawer from falling out when fully extended but will permit easy removal of the drawer when desired. The drawers shall contact live rubber stop bumpers on the inward movement to eliminate noise while in use. The front of the drawers shall be stopped flush with the front apron of the table when in closed position. The drawer shall have one pull if the apron continues along the bottom of the drawer front. The pull shall be of the material specified in 3.1.3.1 and not less than 3 inches long inside.

3.2.5.2 *Drawer dimensions.*—The inside clear dimensions of the drawer shall be not less than 19½ inches wide by 17 inches deep by such height as will be permitted by the height of the apron, however, drawers shall be not less than 2¼ inches high inside.

3.2.6 *Legs.*—The legs shall be knockdown and shall be formed from not less than 18-gage (0.0478 inch) steel, and the outside corner shall be rounded on not less than a $\frac{3}{16}$-inch radius. The legs shall be not less than 3 inches square at the top, uniformly tapered on all sides or on the two inside or outside faces to not less than 2 inches square at the bottom. Legs shall be formed from one piece of steel with the seam on the inside corner. The seam shall be either securely interlocked, full length; or be tightly closed and reinforced by 18-gage angle projection welded on the inside on not more than ½-inch centers; or be continuously and smoothly welded. All legs shall be reinforced by a clamping plate, which shall be welded into the top of the legs. The clamping plate shall be not less than 11-gage (0.1196 inch) steel and shall be the full height of the apron. Means shall be provided for securing the leg through the clamping plate to the apron corner brace by a nut, lockwasher and bolt not less than ⅜ inch in diameter, similar to figure 1. The legs shall be easily removable by the use of simple tools when desired, but must be rigid and free from play in any direction when secured in place. Each leg shall be fitted with a foot socket as specified in 3.1.3.2.

3.2.7 *Aprons.*—The aprons shall be formed of 18-gage (0.0478 inch) steel and shall extend on all sides not less than 4⅜ inches or more than 6¼ inches below the underside of the top plate, and the ends shall be flanged not less than ¾ inch and tapered to fit the taper of the legs. The aprons shall be securely welded to the table top or be securely fastened to a ledge apron which shall be welded to the top plate. The leg attaching clamp or apron corner braces shall be as shown in figure 1, and shall be formed from not less than 11-gage (0.1196 inch) steel, and be securely interlocked or welded to the ends of each apron. The bottom edge of aprons shall be channeled, with inside flange extending up not less than ¼ inch to eliminate contact with rough surfaces.

3.3 *Finish.*—All exterior and interior steel surfaces of the tables, except hardware, shall be prepared for painting in accordance with 3.1.4.1. All surfaces of the tables and drawers shall be enameled. The enamel shall conform to the requirements of 3.1.4.2. The minimum total finished film thickness on exposed enameled surfaces shall be not less than 1.0 mil. The finish shall level out to produce smooth, uniform exposed surfaces without runs, wrinkles, grit, areas of thin film or no film, and separation of color. Finish panels shall withstand the test specified in 4.3.3.

3.4 *Identification marking.*—Unless otherwise specified, each table shall be permanently marked on the underside of the drawer in a plain and legible manner with the specification number, the Federal stock number, the date of manufacture, and the manufacturer's name or trademark, so that the source of supply may be readily determined. When specified, each table shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-130.

3.5 *Workmanship.*—The tables shall be constructed in strict accordance with the detailed requirements specified herein and be of the design as shown in figure 1. The edges of all parts and sheets shall be further protected by folding, beading, flanging, or grinding to insure the elimination of possible injury from burrs or raw edges. The tables shall be free from any other defects which may affect the durability, serviceability, or appearance.



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## 4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

**4.1 Sampling for lot acceptance.**

**4.1.1** *Inspection lot.* — Normally, the inspection lot size shall consist of all units submitted for inspection at one time.

**4.1.2** *Sampling for inspection.*—A representative random sample shall be taken from the lot in accordance with table I. Acceptance or rejection of the lot shall be based on the number of defective units found in the sample when inspected, as being equal to or less than the specified acceptance number, or equal to or greater than the specified rejection number of table I.

TABLE I.—*Sampling for visual and dimensional inspection based on Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 2.5 percent*

| Lot size | Sample size | Acceptance number | Rejection number |
|---|---|---|---|
| 15 and under . | 3 | 0 | 1 |
| 16 to 40 ..... | 7 | 0 | 1 |
| 41 to 110 ..... | 15 | 1 | 2 |
| 111 to 300 ..... | 35 | 2 | 3 |
| 301 to 500 ..... | 50 | 3 | 4 |
| 501 and over .. | 75 | 4 | 5 |

NOTE 1.—The Government inspector may institute tightened or reduced inspection in accordance with section 9 of Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

NOTE 2.—The above is a single sampling procedure. Alternate double or multiple sampling procedures of alternate Acceptable Quality Levels for different classes of defects may be specified at the discretion of the procuring agency.

**4.2 Inspection.** — The tables shall be inspected to determine compliance with this specification as to workmanship, materials, design, details of construction, hardware, finish, marking and packing. Inspection may be made at the factory by a representative of the Government at any time during process of manufacture, or at the point of delivery.

**4.3 Tests.**

**4.3.1** *Top test.* — After satisfactory preliminary inspection has been performed, a table, fully assembled, shall be subjected to the following test: A weight of not less than 550 pounds shall be applied for at least 5 minutes to an area not to exceed 12 inches in diameter. The test area shall be in the center of the table top. The table top shall not deflect more than ⅛ inch and shall not take on any permanent set.

**4.3.2** *Bend tests for steel sheets.*—The steel sheets used for parts to be formed shall withstand a 180-degree bend at room temperature with and across the grain without showing any crystallization, cracks or fractures on the outside of the bend.

**4.3.3** *Finish.*—A panel prepared in accordance with 3.3 shall be bent at room temperature around a ¼-inch rod to 180 degrees, without cracking, flaking, or loss of adhesion evident in the finish.

## 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

**5.1 Application.**—Subject commodity shall be packaged and packed for domestic shipment (immediate use), domestic shipment (storage), overseas shipment (commercial export), or overseas shipment (military), as specified (see 6.1).

**5.1.1** *Domestic shipment (immediate use).*—Unless otherwise specified, the equipment shall be packaged and packed in a manner which will insure arrival at destination in satisfactory condition, and which will be acceptable to the carrier at lowest rates.

**5.2 Domestic shipment (storage).**—When specified.

**5.2.1** *Packaging.*—The legs shall be removed from each table and the bolts shall be placed in a cloth bag and tied to the frame of the table top. The legs shall be individually wrapped in two thicknesses of glazed kraft paper, then overwrapped in pairs in at least two thicknesses of single-face corrugated material and the wrap secured. The bundled legs shall be placed on the bottom of the table within the appron and secured with tape to prevent movement. The complete table top shall be covered with a sheet of 60 pound basis weight (24 by 36—500) glazed paper, folded over the edges and taped in place



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on the underside of the top. Table shall be padded with excelsior pads, cellulose wadding blankets, or equivalent padding materials at all points of contact with walls of shipping container.

**5.2.2** *Packing.* — Tables, packaged as specified in 5.2.1 shall be packed in end opening style OLC full overlap corrugated fiber boxes conforming to Federal Specification LLL–B–631, domestic type style A or B cleated plywood boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP–B–601 or nailed wood boxes conforming to Federal Specification NN–B–621. All flaps of fiber boxes shall be securely sealed with an adhesive commercially used for the specific product being packaged by application throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps. The gross weight of wood boxes shall not exceed approximately 200 pounds; fiber boxes shall be subject to the weight limitations of the fiber box specification.

**5.3 For overseas shipment (commercial export).** — When specified, subject commodity shall be packed in containers which, together with packaging, wrapping and inner packing are acceptable by ocean-going vessels for safe transportation to the points of destination specified in the shipping instructions at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies.

**5.4 For overseas shipment (military).** — When specified.

**5.4.1** *Packaging.* — Packaging shall be as specified in 5.2.1.

**5.4.2** *Packing.*—Tables, packaged as specified in 5.2.1, shall be packed in overseas type cleated plywood boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP–B–601, or nailed wood boxes conforming to Military Specification JAN–P–106. Each shipping container shall be provided with a waterproof case liner conforming to type I or II, grade B, class 2, barrier-material L–2 or M of Military Specification MIL–L–10547, sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto. The gross weight of boxes shall not exceed approximately 200 pounds.

**5.5 Marking.** — Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129. The approved item name is Tables, Steel, General Office.

## 6. NOTES

**6.1 Ordering data.**—Purchasers should specify the size and the color of finish of the tables required, or if a different AQL, or packing for domestic shipment for (storage) or for overseas shipment is required. (See 1.2.1, 1.2.2, 3.2.1.1, 3.4, 4.1, 5.2, 5.3 and 5.4.)

**6.2** Federal Specification do not include all the types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

**6.3** It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

**6.4 Transportation description.**—Transportation description applicable to this item is:

Tables, not otherwise indexed by name, steel,
(Indicate set-up or knocked-down)
Carload weights:
In cars 40′ 9″ or less in length, inside measurements—10,000; 12,000; 15,000; 18,000; 22,000 and 30,000 pounds.
In cars exceeding 40′ 9″ in length, inside measurements—16,000; 18,000; 21,000; 24,000; 30,000 and 40,000 pounds.
Truckload weights:
12,000 pounds, set-up
30,000 pounds, knocked-down.

Minimum weights shown apply when material is transported at classification ratings. They will vary when material moves on commodity rates.



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